story, how long will it take? He will say, Sir, I couldn't do it today. Then what about tomorrow, you will question. Why haven't you done it for three days? You will either make this reporter work or get a new person. If you remove him, the new person will also think that he will have to do the work anyway, come what may, even if they are corrupt. They don't have any option. And he doesn't have any other work. He sits at 8.30 a.m. in the morning on the files.

He wakes up at 3 or 4 a.m. He does pooja etc till 5 a.m. and his other stuff by 8 a.m. Then he is at his office desk by 8.30 a.m. By 9 a.m., we reach. From 10, he starts taking meetings. When he is out of town, it's like a Sunday. If a person works like this, if you do 30 per cent of that, you will see results. Even if you are the most corrupt of corrupt persons, you will still have to show results.

This focus on delivery of government schemes exemplified the social-welfare focus of the BJP. For example, within 100 days of coming to power, Yogi Adityanath's government issued the first public report card of its work on welfare schemes. Unlike detailed government reports, this was aimed at the general public, filled with colourful pages and photographs, enumerating results across a number of schemes, from those addressing sugarcane farmers to village electricity to water for fields.[32] The UP government has since continued to publish similar periodic report cards.[33] A detailed analysis of the performance of these schemes is outside the purview of this book. But the political focus on governmental schemes was clear (more details in Chapter 8).

Between 2013 and 2019, the BJP swept four elections in UP: two Lok Sabha polls (2014 and 2019), one assembly election (2017), nine by-elections and municipal elections in 2018. Senior state BJP leaders attributed this upswing in political fortunes in great measure to the political mobilisation around welfare. They attribute it to what they call 'sushasan' [good governance] and a victory of welfare politics. The election results over six years showed that the initial win of 2014 was not a 'momentary victory', says Dinesh Sharma.[34]

Many people tried to portray the 2014 win as a mere coincidence, but the way Modiji worked for the welfare of the poor, no party has